

**TABLE 17** Hierarchical rankings of first- and second-line treatments recommended for maintenance treatment in bipolar disorder

|                               | Level of evidence by phase of treatment |                          |                     |                |       | Considerations for treatment selection |                       |                  |                       |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|----------------|-------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|-----------------------|
|                               | Maintenance                             |                          |                     | Acute          |       | Acute                                  |                       | Maintenance      |                       |
|                               | Prevention of any mood episode          | Prevention of depression | Prevention of mania | Depression     | Mania | Safety concerns                        | Tolerability concerns | Safety concerns  | Tolerability concerns |
| <b>First-line treatments</b>  |                                         |                          |                     |                |       |                                        |                       |                  |                       |
| Lithium                       | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | +                                      | +                     | ++               | ++                    |
| Quetiapine                    | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | +                                      | ++                    | ++               | ++                    |
| Divalproex                    | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | -                                      | +                     | ++ <sup>c</sup>  | +                     |
| Lamotrigine                   | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ■     | ++                                     | -                     | -                | -                     |
| Asenapine                     | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | n.d.           | ●     | -                                      | +                     | -                | +                     |
| Quetiapine + Li/DVP           | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | +                                      | ++                    | +++ <sup>c</sup> | ++                    |
| Aripiprazole + Li/DVP         | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | +                                      | +                     | ++ <sup>c</sup>  | ++                    |
| Aripiprazole                  | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | ■              | ●     | -                                      | +                     | -                | +                     |
| Aripiprazole OM               | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | n.d.           | n.d.  | -                                      | +                     | -                | +                     |
| <b>Second-line treatments</b> |                                         |                          |                     |                |       |                                        |                       |                  |                       |
| Olanzapine                    | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ● <sup>b</sup> | ●     | +                                      | ++                    | +++              | ++                    |
| Risperidone LAI               | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | n.d.           | n.d.  | -                                      | +                     | +                | ++                    |
| Risperidone LAI (adj)         | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | n.d.           | n.d.  | +                                      | ++                    | +++              | ++                    |
| Carbamazepine                 | ●                                       | ●                        | ●                   | ●              | ●     | ++                                     | ++                    | + <sup>c</sup>   | ++                    |
| Paliperidone (>6 mg)          | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | n.d.           | ●     | -                                      | +                     | +                | ++                    |
| Lurasidone + Li/DVP           | ● <sup>d</sup>                          | ● <sup>e</sup>           | ●                   | ●              | n.d.  | +                                      | ++                    | ++ <sup>c</sup>  | ++/-                  |
| Ziprasidone + Li/DVP          | ●                                       | n.d. <sup>a</sup>        | ●                   | ■              | ■     | ++                                     | ++                    | ++ <sup>c</sup>  | +                     |

DVP, divalproex; LAI, long-acting injectable; Li, lithium; OM, once monthly.

●, level 1 evidence; ●, level 2 evidence; ●, level 3 evidence; ●, level 4 evidence; ■, level 1 negative evidence; ■, level 2 negative evidence; ■, level 3 negative evidence; ■, level 4 negative evidence; n.d., no data; - limited impact on treatment selection; +, minor impact on treatment selection; ++, moderate impact on treatment selection; +++, significant impact on treatment selection.

<sup>a</sup>Did not separate from placebo in those with index mania; no studies available in index depression.

<sup>b</sup>Did not separate on core symptoms of depression.

<sup>c</sup>Divalproex and carbamazepine should be used with caution in women of child bearing age.

<sup>d</sup>Trend for superiority on the primary efficacy measure, hence the lower rating.

<sup>e</sup>Effective in those with an index episode of depression.

[Colour table can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](http://wileyonlinelibrary.com)]